

KEEP THIS ONE; IT'S BUILT TO LIVE ON YOUR DESK

AI Foundations & Safety: The One Hard Rule

THE ONE HARD RULE

Never put student personally identifiable information into a public AI tool. Not a name. Not a detail. Ever.

What an AI chatbot actually is

ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, and Copilot don't look up facts; they **predict likely next words**, learned from enormous amounts of text. That's why the writing is fluent, and why it can be smoothly, confidently wrong. In one peer-reviewed test, nearly 20% of the citations an AI produced were entirely invented, and they looked perfect.

The intern is great at

- First drafts: newsletters, routine emails
- Leveling a text you already like (3 reading levels)
- Rubrics, word banks, question sets from your notes
- Reformatting: quiz ⇄ table ⇄ station cards

The intern cannot

- Know your students, or care about them
- Verify its own facts (that's you)
- Be trusted unreviewed with parents or kids
- Make the judgment calls; those stay yours

The posture in five words: AI drafts, the teacher decides. Nothing AI-made reaches a student or family without a human reading it first.

What counts as student PII

The obvious

- Names, initials, photos
- Student ID numbers
- Grades & test scores tied to a student
- Addresses, family details

The sneaky

- Initials + context ("J.M., 3rd period, anxiety dx")
- One-of-a-kind details (the only new student from Ukraine)
- IEP / 504 contents & accommodations
- Discipline or health specifics

The test: could anyone who knows our school figure out who this is? If yes, it doesn't go in the box. (Deleting the chat later doesn't undo what the company received.)

De-identify like a pro: the 3 moves (≈10 seconds)

Move	Instead of...	Write...
1 · Strip identity	"Jayden Miller's mom"	"a parent"
2 · Generalize	"Sofia R., 7th grade, new arrival"	"a 7th grader new to the school"
3 · Describe the need, not the child	"her reading IEP with 2nd-grade fluency goal"	"rewrite at a 2nd-grade reading level, shorter sentences"

Safe swap: worked example

Unsafe

"Write an email to Jayden Miller's mom about his three missing assignments and his outburst Tuesday."

Safe

"Write a warm, professional email to a parent about a middle schooler with several missing assignments and a recent difficult day in class. Firm but supportive; end by inviting a conversation." → add the name after it's back in your own email account.

Public tool vs. approved tool: everything you signed up for yourself is a public tool. If our district formally adopts a vetted AI platform with a student-data agreement, you'll be told explicitly what changes. Until then, the rule applies everywhere.

Starter prompts: safe by design, tested in classrooms

Families & communication

- "Write a warm, professional newsletter blurb for families about [event], under 120 words."
- "Make this note to families friendlier without losing the deadline: [paste your draft]."

Planning & differentiation

- "Rewrite this passage at three reading levels (2nd, 4th, and 6th grade). Keep the key ideas: [paste]."
- "Give me five different warm-up questions on [topic], from recall to open-ended."

Assessment

- "Create a five-question review quiz on [topic], mixed difficulty, with an answer key."
- "Turn these notes into a 4-level rubric with student-friendly language: [paste notes]."

The move that changes everything: push back. "Warmer." "Shorter." "A 5th grader wouldn't know three of these words — fix that." Two rounds minimum. The first draft is the intern's draft; the third one is yours.

Our three commitments

1. No student PII in public AI tools. Ever.
2. A human reviews everything AI-drafted before it reaches a student or family.
3. We share what works. A prompt that saved you an hour belongs in the staff room.

My notes

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